

BUSINESS ANALYST ROADMAP

1. Understand the Business Objective

Start by identifying the main goal of the business and the decisions that need support.

For a restaurant portfolio such as SkyCity, ask:

- Which restaurants are most profitable?
- Which venues are underperforming?
- What costs are affecting margins?
- Which categories or periods drive the most revenue?

2. Define the Problem and KPIs

A business analyst translates business issues into measurable targets.

Key KPIs may include:

- Revenue
- Gross profit
- Net profit margin
- Cost of goods sold (COGS)
- Labor cost percentage
- Average spend per customer
- Sales per outlet
- Revenue by category
- Profitability by location

3. Collect and Validate Data

Gather business data from sources such as:

- Sales transactions
- Profit and loss reports
- Cost and payroll data
- Menu/category information

- Historical performance trends

Check for:

- Missing values
- Duplicate records
- Incorrect dates
- Outliers
- Inconsistent data across locations or months

4. Perform Business Analysis

Once the data is clean, analyze the main drivers of performance.

Focus on:

- Trend analysis
- Outlet comparison
- Cost driver analysis
- Peak demand periods
- Category contribution analysis
- Profitability by restaurant

This helps answer questions such as:

- Why is one outlet performing better than another?
- Which costs are increasing too quickly?
- Which products or time periods contribute most to profit?

5. Build Insight-Driven Dashboards

Present analysis visually using:

- Revenue trend charts
- Profitability comparison charts
- Cost breakdowns
- Sales by day or time period
- Outlet ranking dashboards

A dashboard should give managers quick access to the most important business insights.

6. Recommend Actions

The analyst should convert findings into practical decisions.

Examples:

- Reduce low-margin menu items
- Improve staffing during peak hours
- Use promotions in low-demand periods
- Review supplier costs and vendor contracts
- Upgrade or restructure weak-performing venues
- Focus marketing on high-profit customer segments

7. Communicate Findings Clearly

Prepare a business summary with:

- Executive summary
- Key findings
- Root causes
- Recommendations
- Risks and opportunities
- Next steps

The final message should be concise, evidence-based, and decision-focused.

8. Monitor and Improve

Business analysis is ongoing.

After recommendations are implemented, monitor:

- Performance against target
- KPI movement
- Improvement in profit or efficiency
- Whether actions created the expected business impact

9. Business Analyst Mindset

A strong business analyst focuses on:

- Understanding business problems
- Measuring what matters
- Finding the cause behind the numbers
- Turning insights into action
- Communicating clearly with decision-makers

10. Career Path Roadmap

1. Understand the business
2. Collect and clean data
3. Analyze performance and trends
4. Build dashboards
5. Present insights with business storytelling
6. Recommend actions
7. Monitor results and improve strategies

This is the core path for becoming an effective business analyst in a hospitality or restaurant portfolio context.